Audible Preview

Not read aloud: from the opening of Book 1, Never Ending: GOD Ordered Destiny; 689 words, about 4 minutes 27 seconds at 1x.

For my brothers, Reckful Byron and Guy. Eternal in one living math.

Guy wrote on his bedroom wall: “Those who cling to life die.” I add: all live, all die, forever remembering they’re one.

Even if the truth burns, with all its people, the Matheist is the eternal order of infinite minds that, through pure reason, finds and reflects the one truth, even in the dark shadow of any cave.

All I offer is the truth. By the end of this book you might choose to love the truth enough to understand and spread its light to the nations. When the power of love of truth is greater than the love of power of lies, when the lie of two becomes the truth of one, salvation says you’ll return to Eden on earth, enter the kingdom of heaven at hand, within. You’ll not taste death, but everlasting life.

Here is the main idea in plain words. Everything is math: logic, numbers, rules, relations and structure. That includes consciousness, and everything that can possibly exist, be reasonably discussed, or interact with anything else. If feelings are outside physics, how do words spoken or read affect them?

What you feel is what math feels like from inside. What is real is physics, which is math, and so are you. The abstract is real. Nothing can exist outside math, so nothing supernatural can, any more than a square circle. You are one self with every life, in every place and time. Math, one infinite structure, is uncreated, eternal, and indestructible. Math is God. No other god can exist. No god needs to make 2 + 2 = 4, and no god can make it otherwise.

From the first step, the last was set. Nothing could have been different. Not even what I would give anything to change.

On a winter night in Los Angeles, a boy sat alone in his room with a guitar, trying to write his way out of grief. A man later tried writing it away on a blank screen. Both that boy and that man were me. Both my brothers are dead.

God, why did you take away the ones that I most loved? If you're all good and powerful, how could you let this be?

From my song for Guy, written at sixteen.

The Cathedral of Light

When my brother Reckful Byron Bernstein died, millions mourned for him online, and thousands gathered in the Cathedral of Light

for his funeral, in the virtual world of World of Warcraft. Enemies from warring factions laid down their weapons and knelt together, in the greatest armistice of a world built for war. The wolf lay with the lamb and swords turned to plows. A cathedral made of math held real grief and love.

For years after Byron, I ran a loop. I should have called. I should have visited. I should have known. The branches multiplied like an inescapable fractal. Every unanswered text. Every argument. Every silence I now knew, in retrospect, was the last one. I lived inside the ghosts of paths I had not taken. This is a book about why those paths were never mine. I do not mean that as a metaphor.

I had known determinism since I was a boy, the way you know a fact in an argument, an unopened gift. I had not internalized it. On a spring day in April, around Passover and Easter, the birth of salvation, just before Byron’s birthday on May 8, sitting in his kitchen chair and looking out into nature, it clicked. After long pressure, through the dark night of the soul and many dark days of the mind, the proof did to the fiction what pressure does to coal. The illusion of other paths in my timeline collapsed, and my self came out clear as diamond.

I saw the colors of reality the way light fans through a prism: one white light, broken into many bands, every band a mind, all of it the same light. I am that I am. I am you. What follows is why that is not a feeling but a proof.

Production notes

- Length: 689 words. ACX estimates 9,300 words per finished hour, 155 a minute, so about 4 minutes 27 seconds at 1x, inside ACX’s 1 to 5 minutes for a retail sample.
- Made from Gary’s selection of 04:18 on October 15, 2026 (1,070 words, about 6 minutes 54 seconds at 1x, and 5 minutes 21 seconds even at 200 words a minute), with two cuts: the causality paragraph (“Math’s causality runs in discrete steps ...”, 148 words), the hardest to follow by ear, and the two paragraphs after “not a feeling but a proof” (“Dissolved are regret ...” and “It took years to internalize ...”, 214 words).
- Sophie’s passage (“After 4.5 billion years of Earth ...”, 285 words) waits for a longer preview.
- Every paragraph is Book 1’s own text, in the book’s order; “The Cathedral of Light” is its section title, read aloud.
- SO70 T511 (October 20, 2026): remade from Book 1 as it now stands, same selection (Gary’s 04:18 rule: remake it when

those paragraphs change). The opening paragraph now reads “All I offer is the truth. By the end of this book ...”: the broad-audience pass cut “Most people hate the truth. It’s probably not for you, yet.” Guy’s line follows the book’s current wording.